MAYA HAWKINS

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin Expected May 2028

- B.S in Arts and Entertainment Technologies and Certificate in Programming & Computation

The University of Texas at San Antonio | Attended Aug 2024 - May 2026

- B.S. in Computer Science and Minor in Film and Media Studies

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Production & Project Tools: Jira, Agile Workflows, Miro, Design Documentation, Asset Pipelines, Microsoft Office.
- Technical & Creative Tools: Unity, Git/GitHub, VSCode, Maya, Arduino, Adobe Creative Cloud
- Programming Languages: Python, C#, C++, Java, C, HTML/CSS (Proficient) | SQL, JavaScript (Familiar)
- Fluent in Spanish with strong proficiency in speaking, reading, and writing.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

LAIKA Studios | *Software Engineer Intern* | Hillsboro, OR Jun 2026- Aug 2026

- Developed an end-to-end dependency management solution tool adopted across studio technology teams, utilizing Agile workflows to rapidly prototype, design system architecture, and integrate with existing systems.
- Collaborated with internal creative and technical teams to deliver 3 guest-facing interactive Unity exhibits for the Academy Museum of Motion Pictures, managing asset integration pipelines to meet critical launch deadlines.

Walt Disney World Resort | *Cast Member* | Lake Buena Vista, FL Aug 2025 - Dec 2025

- Delivered exceptional guest service to 1600+ guests per day at Walt Disney World Resort's EPCOT, maintaining 98% guest satisfaction while analyzing guest movement and operational flows within immersive environment offerings.
- Completed Disney University's Leadership Excellence certification, implementing learned strategies to resolve guest conflicts and improve team collaboration.
- Conducted a requirements building exercise with the intention to enhance food & beverage operations, derived from 3 hours of interviews with 2 Epcot team leaders.

San Antonio Circuit Makers | *Volunteer Instructor* Apr 2025 - present

- Instructed 30+ students in Arduino programming and electronics, developing hands-on curriculum that increased STEM engagement by 54% and created a fun tactical learning experience focused on design, circuitry, and soldering.
- Supervised and mentored participants through hands-on hardware labs, managing material logistics, soldering safety protocols, and technical direction for students assembling custom PCB modules with integrated light-sensors.

The Escape Game | *Game Guide* | San Antonio, TX May 2025 - Aug 2025

- Managed escape room experiences for over 150 guests monthly, adhering to strict safety protocols, maintaining a +98% satisfaction rate through clear rule explanations, strategic hint-giving, and efficient room resets.
- Trained and guided diverse teams while troubleshooting real-time guest issues, honing skills in clear communication and fast-paced problem-solving through monitoring hardware/interactive game mechanisms during live operations.

PROJECTS & LEADERSHIP

- **LAIKA's 2026 Intern Showcase** - Spearheaded and produced LAIKA's first-ever Intern Project Showcase, leading cross-functional coordination across internal studio teams to market, program, and screen a curated lineup of animated short films made by the 2026 intern cohort.
- **IMAGINATIONS Competition** – Directed project scheduling, scope management, and milestone tracking for a multidisciplinary team creating an immersive themed attraction concept for WDI's Imaginations Competition.
- **Student Short Film** – Coordinated end-to-end post-production workflows for a student short film, managing editing timelines, sound design, and audio mix while maintaining quality control to ensure 100% on-time deliverables.
- **JamMates** (Android Studio – Java, Kotlin, Github) - Managed a group of 4 to develop JamMates, a music recommendation app, implementing a mood-based algorithm to curate personalized playlists for +20 users.
- **Clue: Choose Your Own Adventure** (Python) - Built a Python-based interactive game featuring randomized story generation with 17 unique endings & dynamic graphics, demonstrating proficiency in game logic and UI design.